

Troubleshooting Log

Six real build issues encountered during Phase 1, with root cause and resolution

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This log documents real issues hit during the Phase 1 build — not a cleaned-up version of events, but the actual sequence of symptom → cause → fix. Keeping this kind of record is itself a SOC analyst habit: most production incident response is built on exactly this pattern.

01 — Telegram bot token exposed during development

- SYMPTOM** Bot token was accidentally shared publicly while documenting the build.
- CAUSE** Tokens grant full API control of the bot. Anyone holding the token can send messages, read updates, and impersonate the bot.
- FIX** Immediately revoked the token via `@BotFather` using `/revoke` and generated a new one. The old token is now permanently invalid.

02 — curl command returned: "No such file or directory"

- SYMPTOM** Running a curl command with placeholder text in angle brackets caused bash to throw a "no such file" error.
- CAUSE** Angle brackets `< >` are shell redirection operators. Bash tried to redirect from/to a file matching the placeholder name instead of treating it as a variable.
- FIX** Replaced placeholder text with actual values directly in the command before executing. Never wrap a token or ID in angle brackets when pasting into a shell.

03 — Telegram API returned 404 Not Found

- SYMPTOM** API calls to the Telegram bot returned `{"ok":false,"error_code":404,"description":"Not Found"}`.
- CAUSE** The revoked bot token was still being used in commands after the new token was generated.
- FIX** Retrieved the fresh token from `@BotFather` via `/mybots > API Token` and used it in all subsequent commands.

04 — Wazuh agent registration failed: version mismatch

- SYMPTOM** `sudo /var/ossec/bin/agent-auth -m 127.0.0.1` returned: "Agent version must be lower or equal to manager version."
- CAUSE** The apt repository installed the latest Wazuh agent (4.14.5), newer than the Dockerised manager (4.7.3). Wazuh requires `agent version ≤ manager version`.
- FIX** Removed the newer agent and installed the exact matching version: `sudo apt-get install -y wazuh-agent=4.7.3-1`.

05 — No Telegram alerts despite Wazuh detecting events

- SYMPTOM** `wazuh-logtest` showed alerts firing correctly, but no messages arrived on Telegram.
- CAUSE** Two compounding issues: (1) `wazuh-logtest` is a simulation tool that does not trigger integrations. (2) The integration name in `ossec.conf` was set to `telegram.py` but the actual script was named `custom-telegram`.
- FIX** Corrected the integration name in `ossec.conf` from `telegram.py` to `custom-telegram` using `sed`, then restarted the manager. Verified by running the script manually against a sample JSON alert file first, isolating the integration logic from the detection logic.

06 — Nmap scan on localhost did not trigger a Suricata alert

- SYMPTOM** Running `sudo nmap -sS 127.0.0.1` produced no Telegram alert.
- CAUSE** Suricata monitors network interfaces, not loopback traffic — scanning `127.0.0.1` never touches the monitored interface. The default Suricata ruleset also lacked a port-scan detection rule.
- FIX** Ran the scan against the actual target-lab IP instead, generating real network traffic. Added a custom SYN scan detection rule to `/var/lib/suricata/rules/suricata.rules` and restarted Suricata.

TAKEAWAY

Four of these six issues trace back to a mismatch between what a tool actually does and what it was assumed to do — version compatibility, loopback vs. network interfaces, simulation vs. live triggering, naming consistency across config files. Production troubleshooting is mostly this same pattern at larger scale.